

power. At the most, digital cameras can give you around 50 shots before you start facing power problems. So, keep spare batteries or chargers for rechargeable batteries handy. You can also invest a bit more in the memory storage you have, and this storage can range from 4 MB to 128 MB. If transferring the images to your computer is bothersome, especially with a serial interface, you can think about getting a card reader. This reader just slips into the parallel, serial or USB port of your computer. Epson, with its

print imaging technology, even provides for a card reader inside a printer so that you can directly output to a printer. Also, with a card reader the battery usage is no longer an area of concern.

 Printing your pictures

One of the disadvantages most people feel is that with a digital camera you cannot take prints or that it would become too expensive. Well, it is possible to become your own developer by using photo-quality glossy paper on your

colour inkjet paper, but for best results you should use a printer designed for photo-printing. There are small printers available that can give you an output of 3x5 inches or 4x6 inches and also print text. Remember, if you intend to take photo prints, you need higher resolutions in uncompressed formats. The figures below illustrates the prints you can take with the resolutions:

1024x768	3x5 inch prints
1280x960	4x6 inch prints
1600x1200	8x10 inch prints

MP3 ALL THE WAY

Who doesn't listen to MP3 songs or try to rip them off CDs?
A collection of tips to enhance your MP3 experience

 Making MP3

Alright! You want to create your own MP3 files. Remember to keep in mind certain terms like bitrates and frequencies before you start on your quest

 Creating MP3s

It's not necessary to keep on downloading MP3s to listen to them. It's also possible for you to create MP3s sitting right at home. It's legally permissible to create MP3 backups of existing CDs that you

have purchased. In order to do this, you first download software that allows you to extract audio from CDs (ripping) into Wav files. You then encode the Wav files into MP3s.

Most software do the conversion to Wav in the background so you can seamlessly extract audio from CDs directly. There are a number of software such as MusicMatch Jukebox, Real, Media Jukebox that allow you to do this.

To create an MP3 file with the least glitches, it is essential that you reduce the background activity to a minimum or for that matter ensure that there is no background activity. This is because creation of MP3s is a CPU-intensive process and can take up quite a load. Ensure that you have enough memory to avoid any crashes while creating an MP3.

It's also advisable that you reboot your machine and check the free space

for the Wav files and the MP3 files before you start the process.

 Selecting the right bitrate

The quality of MP3s you get is highly dependent on the bitrate that it has been encoded at. Bitrate refers to the quality of music that a media player will process per second. While higher bitrates will definitely produce better quality, it will also create bigger files.

Also, if you are planning to upload MP3s to your Web site or to a portable MP3 player, then this becomes an important consideration.

For instance, a 64 MB MP3 player will hold about 16 songs at 128 Kbps, but manage only 10 songs if it is encoded at 192 Kbps and even lesser at 256 Kbps. The table below shows the difference in quality as we increase the bitrates.



The Creative Nomad II MP3 player

Bitrate-Quality Reference Sheet

Bitrate (Kbps)	Quality
96	Near CD-quality
128	CD quality with optimal file size
160-192	Noticeable improved quality, around 25 per cent higher file size
256-320	Best quality and maximum bitrate that's possible though bigger file size

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